

A Whole-Animal Approach to Cat Aggression as a Health Signal — Action Checklist

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DOCUMENT YOUR CAT'S BASELINE

- ☐ **Document Your Cat's Baseline, Item 1:** Complete a 20-minute baseline inventory documenting your cat's normal activity levels, movement patterns, and preferred resting spots so you can identify what has changed.
- ☐ **Document Your Cat's Baseline, Item 2:** Record your cat's food relationships including eating speed, appetite changes, and meal completion rates to establish a nutritional baseline that reveals internal health shifts.
- ☐ **Document Your Cat's Baseline, Item 3:** Document your cat's grooming behavior by noting frequency, bald patches, skin issues, and any sudden increases or decreases in self-grooming routines.
- ☐ **Document Your Cat's Baseline, Item 4:** Track your cat's sleep locations and social navigation patterns including where she sleeps, how she greets household members, and where she accepts or rejects touch.

INVESTIGATE MEDICAL CAUSES THOROUGHLY

- ☐ **Investigate Medical Causes Thoroughly, Item 1:** Understand that sudden aggression without environmental change signals an internal medical problem requiring veterinary investigation and diagnostic testing.
- ☐ **Investigate Medical Causes Thoroughly, Item 2:** Ask your veterinarian about the 12 most common pain-related causes of sudden aggression and specifically request diagnostic tests that can detect them.
- ☐ **Investigate Medical Causes Thoroughly, Item 3:** Create a medical timeline format that records when aggression started, what changed in your household, and any personal health shifts to share with your vet.
- ☐ **Investigate Medical Causes Thoroughly, Item 4:** Push back if your vet dismisses behavioral changes as normal aging by requesting specific diagnostic tests for conditions like dental disease or hyperthyroidism.

CONNECT HEALTH CHANGES AND REINTRODUCTION

- ☐ **Connect Health Changes and Reintroduction, Item 1:** Assess whether your own hormone changes such as pregnancy, menstrual cycle shifts, or new medications have coincided with changes in your cat's behavior.

 - ☐ **Connect Health Changes and Reintroduction, Item 2:** Look for a correlation between your personal health changes and your cat's sudden aggression, documenting any timing patterns that emerge.

 - ☐ **Connect Health Changes and Reintroduction, Item 3:** Use a science-based reintroduction protocol that respects your cat's fear while rebuilding household peace step by step rather than forcing immediate interaction.

 - ☐ **Connect Health Changes and Reintroduction, Item 4:** Keep aggressive cats separated during the acute phase while using gradual scent-swapping and controlled reintroduction to prevent further escalation.
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Companion to the full guide in your Lemon Squeezy library — check off each item as you complete it.